itself to be obdurate. So long as it could be regarded as infinitesimally small, i.e. when dealing with higher energies and longer periods of time, everything was in perfect order. But in the general case difficulties would arise at one point or another, difficulties which became more noticeable as higher frequencies were taken into consideration. The failure of every attempt to bridge this obstacle soon made it evident that the elementary quantum of action plays a fundamental part in atomic physics, and that its introduction opened up a new era in natural science. For it heralded the advent of something entirely unprecedented, and was destined to remodel basically the physical outlook and thinking of man which, ever since Leibniz and Newton laid the groundwork for infinitesimal calculus, were founded on the assumption that all causal interactions are continuous.

My futile attempts to fit the elementary quantum of action somehow into the classical theory continued for a number of years, and they cost me a great deal of effort. Many of my colleagues saw in this something bordering on a tragedy. But I feel differently about it. For the thorough enlightenment I thus received was all the more valuable. I now knew for a fact that the elementary quantum of action played a far more significant part in physics than I had originally been inclined to suspect, and this recognition made me see clearly the need for the introduction of totally new methods of analysis and reasoning in the treatment of atomic problems. The development of such methods—in which, however, I could no longer take an active part—was advanced mainly by the efforts of Niels Bohr and Erwin Schrödinger. Bohr, with his atom model and Correspondence Principle, laid the foundation for a reasonable unification of quantum theory with classical theory. Schrödinger, through his differential equation, created wave mechanics, and thereby the dualism between wave and particle.

I have just described how the quantum theory came gradually to occupy the focus of my interest in the field of physics. Eventually, it had to share this prominent position with another principle, which introduced me to a new sphere of ideas. In 1905, Albert Einstein published a paper in the *Annalen der Physik* which contained the basic ideas of the Theory of Relativity, and my acute interest in their development was immediately roused.

In order to preclude a likely misunderstanding, I have to insert here a few explanatory remarks of general character. In the opening paragraph of this autobiographical sketch, I emphasized that I had always looked upon the search for the absolute as the noblest and most worth while task of science. The reader might consider this contradictory to my avowed interest in the Theory of Relativity. But it would be fundamentally erroneous to look at it that way. For everything that is relative presupposes the existence of something that is absolute, and is meaningful only when juxtaposed to something absolute. The often-heard phrase, “Everything is relative,” is both